

TEST 1, WRITING TASK 2

Model answer

Science undoubtedly delivers many benefits to humankind. Some people thus conclude that improving people's lives is the main goal that scientists should pursue. I fully agree with this statement and would like to explain why.

In recent years, the work of scientists has brought invaluable benefits to all of us. There are so many examples to prove this. The use of nanotechnology by surgeons saves lives, the invention of clean energy reduces air pollution, and the production of special filters prevents illness from contaminated water. Science has also made modern life so much more convenient than before. For example, mobile phones and the internet enable us to connect with friends on the other side of the globe in real-time. Thanks to the hard work of the scientist who invented GPS, we can save a lot of time and energy when visiting new places.

I also advocate the view that the goal of science is to help people because technological advances have the potential to do great harm to humanity. Some fear that artificial intelligence could one day become a threat to our existence. Scientists have also developed weapons such as nerve gases and nuclear weapons that could cause unprecedented harm. These concerns would not exist if the focus of scientific work had remained on benefiting people rather than hurting them.

The more philosophical among us may say that science has other loftier aims, such as finding an explanation for our existence. Science has indeed taught us a lot, but its ability to explain the natural world remains limited. Because of this, I strongly believe that scientists should channel their efforts into solving the problems that face our planet today.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This response is in full agreement with the statement that the lives of people should be the main priority of science. However, the conclusion [*solving the problems that face our planet today*] is rather general and does not focus on 'people's lives'. 'Solving the problems that face our planet' does not necessarily mean the same as 'improving people's lives'.

The second paragraph lists recent scientific benefits for people's health [*nanotechnology | clean energy | water filters*] and convenience [*mobile phones | the internet | GPS*], while the third paragraph lists the technological advances that could harm people [*artificial intelligence | nuclear weapons*]. All parts of the question are addressed but the candidate is listing the ideas rather than focusing on the relevance of these ideas to improving people's lives.

Cohesive devices are used appropriately, with successful linking of ideas [*In recent years | I also advocate | such as*], but there is overuse of some terms [*also*].

Vocabulary is used flexibly and demonstrates an ability to communicate precise meaning [*invaluable benefits | do great harm to | loftier aims*].

Similarly, there is a wide range of grammatical structures and complex sentences. The candidate includes complex noun phrases [*the hard work of the scientist who invented GPS*] as well as conditional, comparative and passive structures.

While it is acceptable to [*fully agree*] with the statement, it is often better to present ideas from the opposing view to demonstrate understanding of both sides of the argument.